

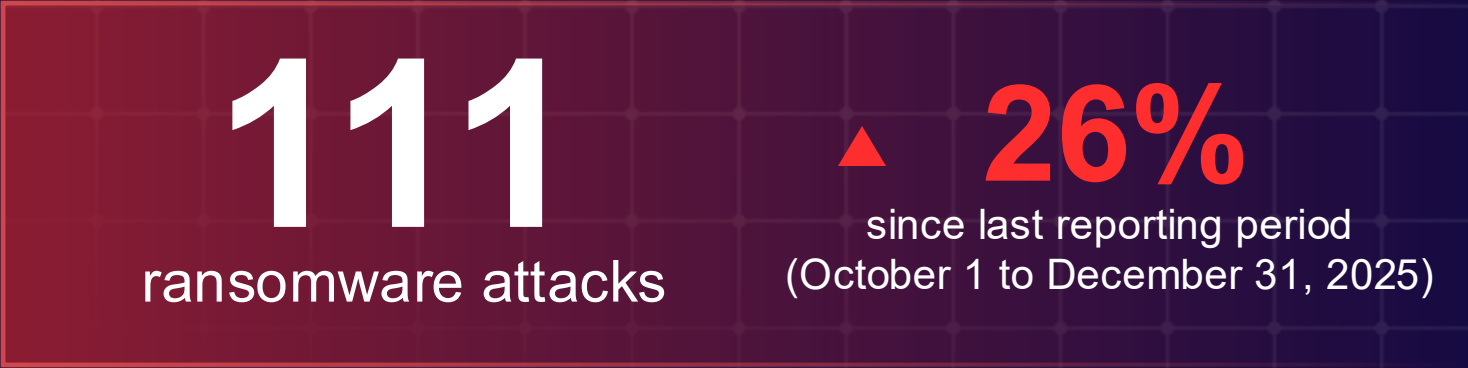


Arts, Entertainment, and Recreation **Threat Landscape** Report

Reporting Period: January 1 to March 31, 2026

Ransomware & Data-Leak Sites

Ransomware remains a top cyber threat to all organizations globally. This section showcases the top ransomware groups targeting the arts, entertainment, and recreation sector and what you can do about them.



Key Points and Recommendations

- Victims posted to data-leak sites in the arts, entertainment, and recreation sector increased between periods, with the latest period showing broader distribution across multiple groups rather than concentration in a few dominant actors.
- "The Gentlemen" appeared only in the latest reporting period, indicating realistic possibility of expanding group churn and shifting operator presence in this sector. "0APT" also was a new group entering into the mix, but the group's postings were later confirmed to be scam/fake.
- Groups such as "Qilin," "Play," and "Lockbit" posted consistently across both periods, suggesting persistent targeting patterns, but most groups' sector activity remained proportional to their all-sector averages, implying opportunistic victim selection.
- Deploy EDR solutions, enforce MFA for external access, and block unapproved file-transfer tools like RClone and FileZilla to mitigate persistent threats from top groups in this sector.



Figure 1: Number of arts, entertainment, and recreation organizations named on data-leak sites vs. the average number of organizations named to data-leak sites across all sectors.

Vulnerability Exploitation

This section explores trends in vulnerability exploitation. It details how quickly attackers are exploiting vulnerabilities, which vulnerabilities are most discussed by cybercriminals and researchers, and key incidents from the reporting period.

The most recent quarter saw average time-to-exploitation rise to 13 days across 41 vulnerabilities, up 61% from 8 days across 46 the prior quarter, likely indicating a shift toward complex, planned-out campaigns rather than easy opportunities. Rapid exploitation also declined, with same-day exploitation dropping from 21 to 10 CVEs and five-day exploitation from 28 to 20, suggesting fewer flaws were immediately or easily exploitable. Key examples include CVE-2026-20963, a Microsoft SharePoint remote code execution (RCE) exploited by multiple threat actors, and CVE-2026-21643, a pre-auth SQL injection in Fortinet FortiClient Endpoint Management Server (EMS) that enables unauthenticated code execution, both likely favored for their broad enterprise exposure.

Popular CVEs

CVE	ReliaQuest Intelligence Mentions
CVE-2026-21509 - Microsoft Office RCE vulnerability	16
CVE-2026-20045 - Cisco Unified Communications critical vulnerability	7
CVE-2026-1731 - BeyondTrust Remote Support critical vulnerability	6
CVE-2026-24858 - Fortinet FortiOS Critical vulnerability	6
CVE-2025-55182 - Meta React Server DOM RCE	6

41

new vulnerabilities exploited

▼ 11%

since last reporting period

Vulnerability Highlights

CVE-2026-33634

CVE-2026-33634 is a CVSS 6.3 embedded malicious code vulnerability in Aqua Security's trivy-action and setup-trivy GitHub Actions. Exploited in the wild since March 19, 2026, the threat actor "TeamPCP" used compromised credentials to inject credential-stealing malware into the tools' version tags, harvesting continuous integration/continuous delivery (CI/CD) pipeline secrets at scale. This incident has since entered a ransomware phase, with the "Vect" ransomware group confirmed as leveraging stolen credentials from this supply-chain compromise to target victims.

Organizations using these tools in their CI/CD pipelines are at direct risk of credential and secrets theft, which can expose cloud environments and downstream systems. A clean version, setup-trivy v0.2.6, is available. Immediately upgrade, rotate all secrets exposed in affected pipelines, and pin GitHub Actions to a specific commit hash rather than mutable version tags per Aqua Security's advisory.

Attacker Target Insights

This section details the initial access attempts that are targeting ReliaQuest’s arts, entertainment, and recreation customers. It also explores how quickly organizations in the sector are responding to threat actor activity. Our agentic AI security operations platform, GreyMatter, allows threats to be detected at the source and in transit. Security teams can contain, investigate, and respond in less than 5 minutes—eliminating Tier 1 and Tier 2 security operations work.

How fast did arts, entertainment, and recreation organizations respond to cyber threats?

The mean time to contain (MTTC) threats increased to 1 hour and 33 minutes during the reporting period, up approximately 745% from 11 minutes since the last reporting period.



During the reporting period, organizations in the arts, entertainment, and recreation sector using ReliaQuest Automated Response Playbooks achieved an average MTTC of 2 minutes when responding to threats.

Top Techniques

According to our customer incident data, attacks targeting the arts, entertainment, and recreation sector nearly doubled during the reporting period, with incident volume increasing by approximately 92%. This rise likely reflects growing attacker interest in the sector's expanding digital footprint and its relatively broad exposure to social engineering.

Phishing techniques overall grew significantly, climbing to 57% from 42% of all observed techniques. Within that, the composition shifted notably: Phishing For Information emerged as the dominant sub-technique at 33%, while Spearphishing Link fell to 16% from 29%. Malicious File use declined, dropping to 2% from 6%, and Email Hiding Rules fell to 0.5% from 3%. Cloud Accounts saw a slight rise to 2% from 1%, potentially indicating growing attacker interest in cloud-based credential access.

Social engineering remains the defining characteristic of this sector's threat profile, with phishing and its variants collectively accounting for the majority of observed activity.

Top MITRE Techniques Targeting Sector

MITRE ATT&CK Technique	Percentage of All Techniques Observed
Phishing for Information	33
Spearphishing Link	16
Spearphishing Attachment	3
Cloud Accounts	2
Internal Spearphishing	2

Digital Risk Protection

This section explores the biggest GreyMatter Digital Risk Protection (DRP) risks to the arts, entertainment, and recreation sector. If a risk is detected, customers receive context-rich alerts via the GreyMatter alert process, with clear response steps including assignment and mitigation recommendations.

There was a rise in credential exposures and a clear decline in impersonating domains and subdomains for the arts, entertainment, and recreation sector. Credential exposure now dominates the alert mix by a wide margin. This shift suggests threat actors are focusing on account-based access over brand spoofing, with a realistic possibility that exposed credentials in this sector are used in credential-stuffing attacks against customer-facing portals.

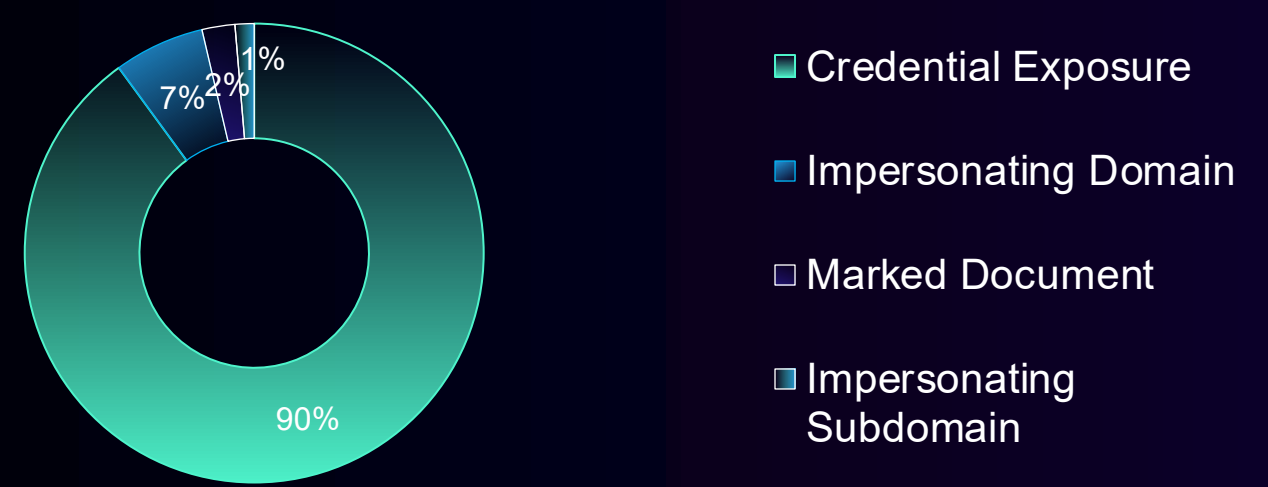


Figure 2: DRP alerts by type for arts, entertainment, and recreation customers this reporting period

All-Sector Top DRP Alerts (for comparison)

Risk Type	Percentage
Credential Exposure	30
Impersonating Domain	24
Impersonating Subdomain	18
Selling Unauthorized Goods	7
Expired Certificate	6

Countries Targeted

Publicly known cyber events targeting organizations in the arts, entertainment, and recreation sector increased significantly in volume, with the US remaining the dominant target at 29% of activity despite its share declining from 38%. Israel rose from 2 to 11 alerts, a 450% increase, likely tied to the ongoing US-Israeli military conflict with Iran, which has driven retaliatory hacktivist and state-linked cyber campaigns against both nations throughout this period.

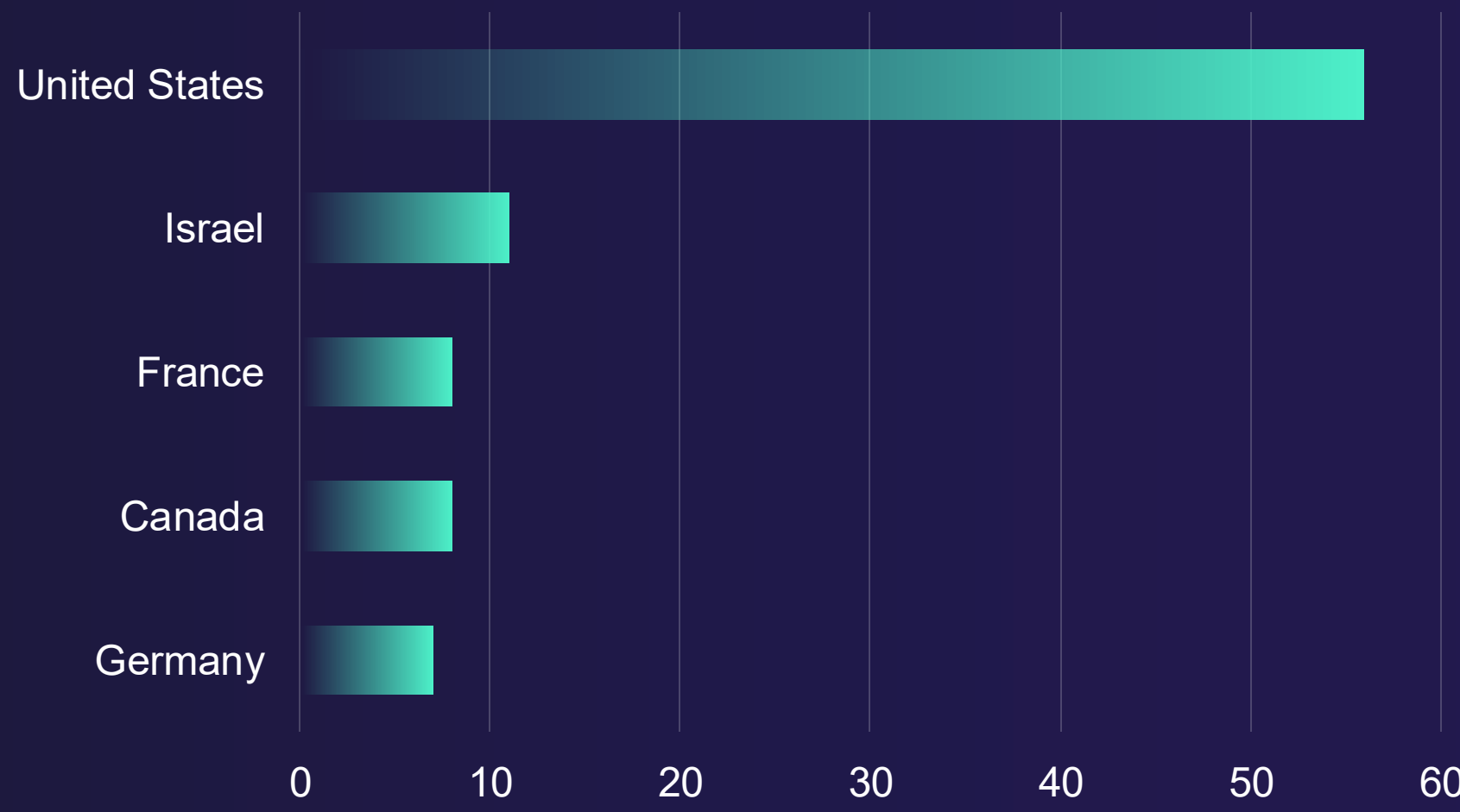


Figure 3: Number of significant cyber events, by region

Notable Developments

Supply-Chain Attack Targets JavaScript Library

A North Korea-linked threat actor, "UNC1069," used social engineering to steal credentials from an Axios maintainer, publishing two trojanized versions containing the "WAVESHAPER.V2" implant. With over 100 million weekly downloads, the arts, entertainment, and recreation sector's JavaScript-dependent platforms and consumer-facing applications face broad exposure to this remote-access trojan (RAT).

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■ March 31, 2026

Device Code Phishing Targets Microsoft 365 Accounts

A device code phishing campaign is compromising Microsoft 365 accounts by abusing legitimate authentication flows to steal valid access and refresh tokens. Threat actors then conduct token replay and suspicious mailbox access, posing a realistic threat of business email compromise (BEC) and data theft to arts, entertainment, and recreation organizations relying on Microsoft 365.

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■ March 31, 2026

FortiClient EMS SQL Injection Actively Exploited

A critical pre-authentication SQLi vulnerability, CVE-2026-21643, in Fortinet FortiClient EMS 7.4.4 is being actively exploited. Arts, entertainment, and recreation organizations using internet-exposed EMS instances face likely credential theft, lateral movement, and endpoint compromise, with exploitation activity likely to increase following a public proof-of-concept release.

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■ March 30, 2026

Notable Developments

Trivy Supply-Chain Compromise Targets Developer Credentials

A supply-chain compromise of Trivy version 0.69.4, a widely used open-source vulnerability scanner in CI/CD pipelines, harvested over 50 credential types, including Secure Shell (SSH) keys, Amazon Web Services (AWS) credentials, and Kubernetes secrets. This threatens the arts, entertainment, and recreation sector, where cloud-based development pipelines supporting digital platforms and content delivery are at risk of credential theft and unauthorized cloud access.

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■ March 20, 2026

Zendesk Brand Impersonation Domains Targeting Users

ReliaQuest identified a surge in domains impersonating Zendesk via typosquatting, linked to "Scattered Lapsus\$ Hunters," targeting credential theft and account takeover. For the arts, entertainment, and recreation sector, compromised support-platform credentials risk unauthorized access to ticketing systems and customer communications, with ongoing infrastructure rotation making point-in-time blocks likely ineffective.

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■ March 9, 2026